

Fig 8.5: Malnourished child

A malnourished person is physically, mentally, socially and emotionally sick. It is of two types:

i. Under nutrition

ii. Over nutrition

8.4 Signs of Well Nourished Child

1. Skin is smooth and shiny with a healthy colour.
2. Bright and clear eyes and pink eye membranes.
3. Firm pink nails.
4. The hair is lustrous and firmly attached to the scalp.
5. Healthy gums and membranes of the mouth.
6. Reddish pink tongue. Not coated, pink lips.
7 Desirable height for age and desirable weight for height.
8. Good appetite and sound nutrition.
9. Normal body temperature, pulse rate and breathing rate.
10. Healthy children are alert.

8.5 Health

The word 'Health' refers to a particular state or condition of the body. According to this definition, a person may not suffer from any disease but still can be unhealthy, if he/she feels tired, lazy or cannot concentrate on

Table 8.1: Types of Malnutrition

Under nutrition	Over nutrition
1. Under nutrition is deficiency of one or more nutrients. 2. It is that state of nutrition in which the quality and quantity of food is not sufficient for the body and is deficient in one or more nutrients. 3. When almost all nutrients are below the requirement, the condition is known as under nourishment. 4. An undernourished person manifests symptoms of deficiencies and feels unwell. Poor body weight, poor resistance to infection, weakness and general ill-health are the symptoms of under nourishment.	1. Over nutrition is excess of one or more nutrients. 2. It is that state of nutrition in which the intake of nutrients is in excess of body needs quantitatively as well as qualitatively causing adverse effect on the body. 3. When almost all nutrients are high requirement, the condition is known as over nourishment. 4. The pathological state resulting from a disproportion of essential nutrients with or without the absolute deficiency of any nutrient as determined by the requirement of a balanced diet.

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